MILITARY SPECIFICATION

PEAS, DEHYDRATED, COMPRESSED

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers dehydrated, compressed, sweet peas for use by the Armed Forces as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

TT-C-495	- Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-C-29	- Canned Subsistence Items, Packaging Of

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8915

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MIL-L-1497	- Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078	- Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

OTHER GOVERNMENT DOCUMENTS

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Office of Drinking Water, WH550, Environmental Protection Agency, Washington, DC 20460.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

U.S Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Market Research and Development Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Peas

(Application for copies should be addressed to Chief, Processed Products Branch, Fruit and Vegetable Quality Division, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

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U.S. Standards for Grades of Fresh Shelled Peas for Canning or Freezing

(Application for copies should be addressed to Fresh Products Branch, FV, AMS, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2048, So. Bldg., Washington, DC 20250.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

2.2 Other publications. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCE

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy of Science, National Research Council, Washington, DC 20418.)

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1160, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

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AMERICAN DRY MILK INSTITUTE, INC.

Standards for Grades of Dry Milk, Including Methods of Analysis: Bulletin 916

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dry Milk Institute, Inc., 130 North Franklin Street, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein (except for associated detail specifications, specification sheets, or MS standards), the text of this document shall take precedence. Nothing in this document, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Bid sample approval. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), 12 cans of at least 6 avoirdupois ounces each representative of the product that the bidder proposes to furnish shall be submitted to the contracting officer. One or more of the samples will be tested to determine whether the product has the desired subjective quality characteristics as specified in 3.5. The remaining samples shall be used as a reference standard for determining compliance of deliveries with subjective quality requirements. Bid samples submitted by the bidder shall be held at a temperature of 40°F or lower until used. Additional samples may be withdrawn from accepted lots of material for use as reference standards as deemed necessary. The contracting officer's approval of the bid samples does not relieve the contractor from complying with all other requirements of the document not stipulated above.

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent and insect infestation, extraneous material, off-flavors, off-odors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Peas. Peas shall be either frozen or fresh, clean, sound, succulent seed of a freezer variety (sweet type). The peas upon rehydration shall meet the requirements of 3.5.2.

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3.2.1.1 Peas, frozen. Frozen peas shall be U.S. Grade A as specified in the U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Peas. Frozen peas may be used provided they have been blanched to peroxidase inactivation or they are further blanched to peroxidase inactivation in accordance with 3.4.1 and thawed to an internal temperature of not less than 35°F before they are sulfited in accordance with 3.4.3.

3.2.1.2 Peas, fresh. Fresh peas shall be U.S. fancy grade as specified in the U.S. Standards for Grades of Fresh Shelled Peas for Canning or Freezing.

3.2.2 Sodium sulfite or sodium bisulfite. The sulfite(s) shall meet the requirements of the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.3 Water. Water used for formulation and washing shall conform to the National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.2.4 Optional ingredients. Ingredients of type and quantity approved by the Food and Drug Administration that may help the product to meet the requirements of 3.5 may be added.

3.3 Size grading. The peas shall be size graded so that not more than 5 percent are less than 10/32 inch in diameter and not more than 5 percent are greater than 14/32 inch in diameter.

3.4 Processing.

3.4.1 Blanching. The fresh peas shall be blanched to the extent necessary to result in inactivation of the peroxidase enzyme, as determined in accordance with 4.3.2.1, and to produce an end product that, upon rehydration, will comply with 3.5.2.

3.4.2 Perforating, slitting, or other mechanical disruption of the skin. The pea skin shall be perforated, slit, or otherwise mechanically treated so that the rehydrated product complies with 3.5.2. If peas are to be slit, they should be size graded into 1/32-inch graduations to ensure uniform slitting. Slitting of peas without size grading results in some peas receiving no slit and others being slit too deeply when exposed to a fixed knife setting. After slitting, the various sieve sizes shall be recombined prior to subsequent processing.

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3.4.3 Sulfiting. Sulfiting shall be accomplished by spraying or dipping the cooked, perforated, slit, or similarly treated peas with or in an aqueous solution of sodium sulfite, sodium bisulfite, or combinations thereof, in such a manner that the distribution is uniform and the sulfite content of the finished product conforms to the level specified in 3.5.1. Contact of the wet peas with iron subsequent to the sulfiting operation shall be strictly avoided.

3.4.4 Freezing. The peas shall be loose-frozen immediately after sulfiting and held in the frozen state until they are dehydrated.

3.4.5 Dehydration. Dehydration shall be by such method that the finished product complies with 3.5. The dehydration conditions shall be such that the product will not be scorched or otherwise damaged by heat or drying. (Note: A satisfactory product has been produced by freeze-drying frozen peas employing plate temperatures that did not exceed 160°F and absolute pressure of 750 microns of mercury until a moisture level of approximately 3 percent was reached.)

3.4.6 Compressing.

3.4.6.1 Conditioning. The dehydrated peas shall be conditioned by adding moisture sufficient to make the peas pliable so that they will not be crushed or ground under high pressure. (Note: Satisfactory compressed peas have been produced by adding moisture until an 8 to 14 percent increase in weight is attained. The moisture may be added by spraying with water until the aforementioned weight increase is achieved and allowing the moisture to equilibrate prior to mechanical compression.)

3.4.6.2 Mechanical compression. The moistened peas shall be placed in the desired molds and compressed, into discs that measure 3 5/8 inches ± 1/8 inch by 1/2 ± 1/16 inch, by applying 1000 to 2500 pounds per square inch of pressure for a dwell time of 5 to 20 seconds, depending upon the variety and maturity of peas.

3.4.6.3 Redrying. The compressed peas shall be redried with a minimum of delay so that the finished product complies with 3.5.

3.5 Finished product.

3.5.1 Compressed product. The moisture content of the compressed peas shall not exceed 3.0 percent, by weight, and the sulfite content (calculated as sulfur dioxide) shall be 500 ± 250 parts per million (ppm), by weight.

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3.5.2 Rehydrated product requirements. The compressed peas shall rehydrate rapidly (12 to 15 minutes) upon the addition of boiling water to each whole disc in the proportion of 7 fluid ounces of boiling water to each avoirdupois ounce of peas. The rehydrated product shall have the odor, flavor, texture, and color typical of freshly cooked green peas. The peas shall be free from foreign material such as glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal; foreign odor or flavor such as burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale; or foreign color. Each 28 avoirdupois ounces of drained rehydrated product shall contain no more than the following:

a. One piece or a combination of pieces of flat vegetable material common to the pea plant having an aggregate area of more than 1/4 square inch (1/2 inch by 1/2 inch) on the surface.

b. Not more than one spherical, nondeleterious or nonpoisonous type of thistle bud or nightshade berry.

c. A piece or combination of pieces not exceeding 1/2 inch in length in the aggregate of cylindrical vegetable material such as stems common to the pea plant or from other plants that are similar in color to the peas.

d. Not more than 10 percent, by count, of pieces of peas (i.e., a whole pea from which a cotyledon or a large portion thereof has become separated, two detached whole cotyledons, pieces of detached cotyledon aggregating the equivalent of an average size cotyledon, and a whole detached skin or portions of detached skin aggregating the equivalent of an average size whole skin). The percent, by count, of pieces of peas shall be determined by dividing the total number of pieces of peas by the total number of peas and pieces of peas. (A pea held together by its skin, even though the cotyledons are partly crushed, is considered an unbroken pea.)

e. Not more than a total of 3 percent, by count, of blemished and seriously blemished peas and not more than 1 percent, by count, of seriously blemished peas. A blemished pea is one that has been blemished by discoloration or by other means but not to the extent that its appearance or eating quality has been materially affected. A seriously blemished pea is one that is spotted, discolored, or otherwise blemished to an extent that the appearance is seriously affected.

f. Not more than 1/2 percent, by count, of blond or cream colored peas.

g. Not more than 9 percent, by count, of unrehydrated peas (i.e., peas that are shriveled, not having rehydrated to approximately their original shape, based on product rehydration as specified).

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3.5.3 Palatability. The product shall be equal to or better than the approved bid sample in palatability and overall appearance.

3.6 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared, processed, and packaged in establishments meeting the requirements of Title 21, Code of Federal Regulations, Part 110: Current Good Manufacturing Practice in Manufacture, Processing, Packaging or Holding of Human Foods; and the plant sanitation requirements of the appropriate Government inspection agency.

3.7 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and reponsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this document. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of supervision necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this document.

4.3 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.3.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.3.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, or compliance shall be evident by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. In addition, prior to use, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically, as necessary, to determine

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conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient lot or component lot or of any involved product.

4.3.1.2 Unfilled can inspection. Conformance of unfilled cans to the requirements specified in 5.1.1 shall be determined by examination of certificates of conformance or other valid documents. Any nonconformance shall be cause for rejection of the can lot or of any involved product.

4.3.1.3 Grading. Prior to processing, the peas shall be examined to determine compliance with size as specified in 3.3. The sample shall be 5 pounds of peas. Use of peas not conforming to size requirements shall be cause for rejection of the involved finished product.

4.3.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, filling, sealing, and packaging requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.3.2.1 In-process testing for peroxidase activity. As each production run is initiated, a 1-pound sample of blanched peas, prior to dehydration, shall be tested. If the test result for peroxidase enzyme is negative, further testing for peroxidase activity need be accomplished only as often as there is a change in the amount or quality of the peas or until procedures and controls applicable to the blanching process are changed. A test indicating active peroxidase enzyme shall be cause for rejection of that portion of the production from the time of the previous negative result until such time as a negative test result is again attained. The test to show adequate blanching shall be made in accordance with the following methods:

a. Reagents:

(1) Distilled water.
(2) 0.5 percent guaiacol in 50 percent ethyl alcohol solution.
(3) 0.08 percent hydrogen peroxide (2.8 milliliters (mL) of 30 percent hydrogen peroxide per liter). Keep in refrigerator in dark bottle and renew solution each week or two.
(4) Clean sand.

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b. Apparatus:

(1) Test tubes, 3/4 or 7/8 inch in diameter.
(2) Funnels, 3 or 4 inches in diameter.
(3) Cotton milk filters, 6 or 7 inches.
(4) Waring blender or similar mixer, or porcelain mortar (4- to 6-inch diameter) and pestle.
(5) Graduated cylinder, 50 mL.
(6) Pipettes, 1 and 2 mL.
(7) Timer or watch with second hand.
(8) Test tube rack.
(9) Balance that will weigh 10-gram samples to ± 0.1 gram (a triple-beam or accurate digital display type balance is recommended). If blender is used, a larger sample will permit use of less sensitive balance.

c. Procedure using blender:

(1) Weigh out representative 100- to 200-gram sample.
(2) Place in blender with 3 mL of water to each gram of vegetable.
(3) Grind for 1 minute at moderate or high speed.
(4) Filter through cotton milk filter.
(5) Add 2 mL of filtrate to 20 mL of distilled water in test tube.
(6) Prepare a blank by adding 2 mL of filtrate to 22 mL of distilled water in a second test tube, mix, and use as a color comparison tube. (Do not add any guaiacol or peroxide to this tube.)
(7) Add 1 mL of 0.5 percent guaiacol solution to first test tube without mixing.
(8) Add 1 mL of 0.08 percent hydrogen peroxide to the same tube without mixing.
(9) Mix contents thoroughly by inverting and watch for development of any color differing from the blank, regardless of hue, but of sufficient intensity to show an obvious contrast. Development of color is a positive test and indicates inadeqate blanching. If no color contrast develops in 3 1/2 minutes, consider the test negative and the product adequately blanched. If color develops after 3 1/2 minutes, it is to be disregarded and the test still considered negative. (For further information see full report, Masure, M.P. and Campbell, H., "Rapid Estimation of Peroxidase in Vegetables Extracts - An Index of Blanching Adequacy for Frozen Vegetables", Fruit Prod. Jour. and Amer. Food Mfr. 23:369-375, 383, Aug 1944.)

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d. Procedure using mortar:

(1) Weigh representative 10-gram sample.
(2) Measure 30 mL of distilled water in graduated cylinder.
(3) Place sample in mortar with a little clean sand, add minimum amount of water from graduated cylinder to give best consistency for thorough maceration, and grind for 3 minutes. Add remainder of water from cyclinder and mix.
(4) Proceed as under (c), steps 4 through 9 inclusive.

NOTE: Because of the limits of mortar grinding when using mortar with 10-gram samples, special attention should be given to ensuring representative samples. Sample size can be increased to 20 to 30 grams with additional time given to grinding, or the number of units represented can be increased by halving or quartering, if the sample is uniform.

4.3.3 Net weight examination. The filled and sealed cans shall be examined for net weight. The lot size shall be expressed in cans. The sample unit shall be one can of discs. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce. Any individual net weight of less than 18.5 ounces shall be scored as a minor defect. The inspection level shall be S-3, and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5. In addition, the lot shall be rejected if the sample average net weight is less than 19.0 ounces.

4.3.4 Finished product examination. The peas shall be examined for the defects listed in table I. The lot size shall be expressed in terms of cans of discs. The sample unit shall be a sufficient amount of the product originating from one can to yield 28 ounces of drained, rehydrated product, prepared in accordance with 3.5.2. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5.

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TABLE I. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Contains pea plant material having an aggregate area greater than 1/4 square inch on the surface
102	More than one spherical nonpoisonous type of thistle bud, nightshade berry
103	Cylindrical pea plant material exceeding 1/2 inch in length
104	More than 10 percent, by count, of pieces of peas
105	More than 3 percent, by count, of total blemished and seriously blemished peas
106	More than 1 percent, by count, of seriously blemished peas
107	More than 1/2 percent, by count, of blond or cream colored peas
108	More than 9 percent, by count, of unrehydrated peas based on product rehydration as specified

1/ The presence of any foreign material (e.g., glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal), foreign odor or flavor (e.g., burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved bid sample in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an Agricultural Marketing Service agent.)

4.3.5 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed cans shall be in accordance with the U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers, except that inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4).

4.3.6 Leakage inspection (gas packed cans). Inspection for leakage shall be in accordance with PPP-C-29 (see 5.1.1).

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4.3.7 Vacuum inspection (vacuum packed cans). Inspection for vacuum shall be in accordance with PPP-C-29 (see 5.1.1).

4.3.8 Oxygen in headspace testing (applicable to gas packed cans). The filled and sealed cans shall be tested for oxygen in headspace in accordance with the Determination of Oxygen method in Bulletin 916 of the American Dry Milk Institute, Inc. Alternatively, the headspace oxygen content may be determined by an Instrumentation Laboratories Oxygen Analyzer or equivalent instrument. Test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result failing to conform to the oxygen in headspace requirements in 5.1.1 shall be classified as a major defect. When referee testing is necessary, the American Dry Milk Institute Method shall be followed. The lot size shall be expressed in cans. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed can. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

4.3.9 Moisture and sulfur dioxide content testing. The finished product shall be tested as specified in 4.3.9.1 and 4.3.9.2 for conformance to the moisture and sulfur dioxide requirements in 3.5.1. The sample unit for testing shall be an 8-ounce composite derived from the number of cans indicated by inspection level S-2. The lot size shall be expressed in cans. Results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent for moisture and nearest ppm for sulfur dioxide. Any test failure shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.3.9.1 Moisture determination of finished product. Prepare a clean, dry high-speed blender or similar mill by grinding a sample and discarding it. Grind approximately 100 grams of a well-mixed sample in the prepared blender. Sieve the ground material through a U.S. Standard No. 20 sieve and collect the portion that passes through in a clean, dry, tightly closed container. Weigh two samples, approximately 2 grams each, of the sieved material into tared, dry, aluminum weighing dishes (approximately 2 or 2 1/2 inches in diameter and 3/4 inch in depth) with tight-fitting covers. Place the dishes with cocked lids in a vacuum oven and dry for 6 hours at 70°C under a pressure of not more than 100 mm mercury. During drying, admit to the oven a slow current of air (approximately two bubbles per second) dried by passing through concentrated sulfuric acid. Remove the dishes and allow them to cool in a desiccator before weighing. Calculate the percent of moisture in the original samples.

4.3.9.2 Sulfur dioxide content. Sulfur dioxide content of the ground sample shall be determined in accordance with Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Food Additives: Direct, section: Sulfurous Acid (Total) in Food.

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4.3.10 Shipping container examination. When shipping containers are required to be in accordance with PPP-B-636, examination for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement shall be in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows:

Major:	National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible
	Number of cans not as specified
	Reinforced with other than nonmetallic strapping or tape
Minor:	Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible
	Interior packing with fiberboard pad not as specified
	Container not snug fitting
	Arrangement of cans not as specified

Level C shipping containers shall be examined for the markings, arrangement, and number of cans defects specified above and for the closure method specified in 5.2.3.

4.3.11 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. The product shall be preserved in accordance with level A or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. A net weight of 19.0 ounces of the discs shall be unit packed in a size 401 by 411, open top style, round, metal can with soldered or welded side seam or one-piece drawn body and compound-lined, double-seamed ends. A tolerance of 0.5 ounce will be allowed in any one container, provided the average net weight of the cans is not less than 19.0 ounces. The can shall be made throughout from not less than 0.25-pound electrolytic tin plate per base box. Alternatively, the can ends may be fabricated from ECCS plate, fully enameled both inside and outside. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I of TT-C-495. The can shall be hermetically sealed, and the oxygen content of the gases in the filled and sealed container shall not exceed 2.0 percent when tested in accordance with 4.3.8. Alternatively, the can may be hermetically sealed under conditions which result in a vacuum of not less than 27 inches of mercury when examined in accordance with procedures in PPP-C-29. When cans are closed under vacuum, the oxygen requirement is not applicable. The gas packed can shall not leak when examined in accordance with the procedure in PPP-C-29.

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5.1.2 Level C. Discs shall be unit packed in accordance with 5.1.1 except that cans with or without commercial exterior coating will be acceptable. Alternatively, cans may be made from 0.20 pound per base box electrolytic tin plate that is coated with a commercial exterior coating.

5.2 Packing. Twenty-four cans of discs, arranged four in length, three in width, and two in depth, shall be packed on end in a snug-fitting shipping container in accordance with level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. The shipping container shall be a fiberboard box constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The tiered cans shall be separated with a full length and width fiberboard pad made of the same material as the box. The pads shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width interior dimensions of the box. Each shipping container shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1). Strapping of unit loads shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. The shipping container shall be a fiberboard box constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC, grade V3c, V3s, or V4s of PPP-B-636. The tiered cans shall be separated with a full length and width fiberboard pad made of the same material as the box. The pads shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width interior dimensions of the box. Each shipping container shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C packing. The shipping container shall be in accordance with National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable, except the closure of the fiberboard boxes shall be in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.3 Unit loads. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.2 and 5.2.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified. When unit loads are strapped, strapping should be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.4 Labeling and marking.

5.4.1 Cans. Cans of discs shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497 and shall contain the following information:

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PEAS, DEHYDRATED, COMPRESSED

Net weight - No. 2 1/2 can - 19 ounces
Name and address of supplier
Date packaged
Preserved with sulfur dioxide

DIRECTIONS FOR USE

Peas, dehydrated, compressed - 1 can (19 oz)	
Water, boiling	4 qt
Butter	2 oz (4 tbsp)
Salt	1 tbsp

Place peas and seasonings in pan. Pour boiling water over peas. Stir to moisten. Cover and let stand 12 to 15 minutes.

Yield: 25 servings (1/2 cup).

NOTE: When preparing in quantity, peas and seasoning may be added to boiling water. Turn off heat, stir, cover, and let stand 12 to 15 minutes.

GAS PACKAGED (when applicable)

5.4.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.4.3 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. When other than 12 bid samples are required (see 3.1).
c. Level of preservation and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
d. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is specified (see 5.2.1 and 5.3).

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6.2 Level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the contracting oficer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15, NAVSUPINST 4030.28, AFT 71.06, MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7, as applicable.

6.3 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8915-0556

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MC, MS
DLA - SS

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1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-P-43873A	Peas, Dehydrated, Compressed

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b Recommended Wording

c Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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